

HumAid

Locally relevant Humanitarian Aid knowledge
management and alert system

<https://humaid.app>

Problem

The knowledge to save lives already exists, and is unreachable in the moment it matters. Brazil and Spain floods in recent years. Several in Colombia (Mocoa, La Mojana) every event is documented in hundreds of pages... same lessons get re-learned every La Niña cycle.

Communication problem: Risk maps are written in GIS / SAR jargon nobody in the wetland reads. Cloud-based satellite imagery arrives days late and depends on bandwidth that isn't there. Numerical alerts ("Río Putumayo 11.5 m") don't translate to "what do I do?". And the network the cloud-based response runs on is the first thing the flood destroys.

Humanitarian response is information-bound, not only resource-bound. The institutions and the data exist. What's missing is the link that delivers **the right answer to the right person, at the right time** on a device that works without internet.

Problem

The knowledge matters. Brazil's every event is do Niña cycle.

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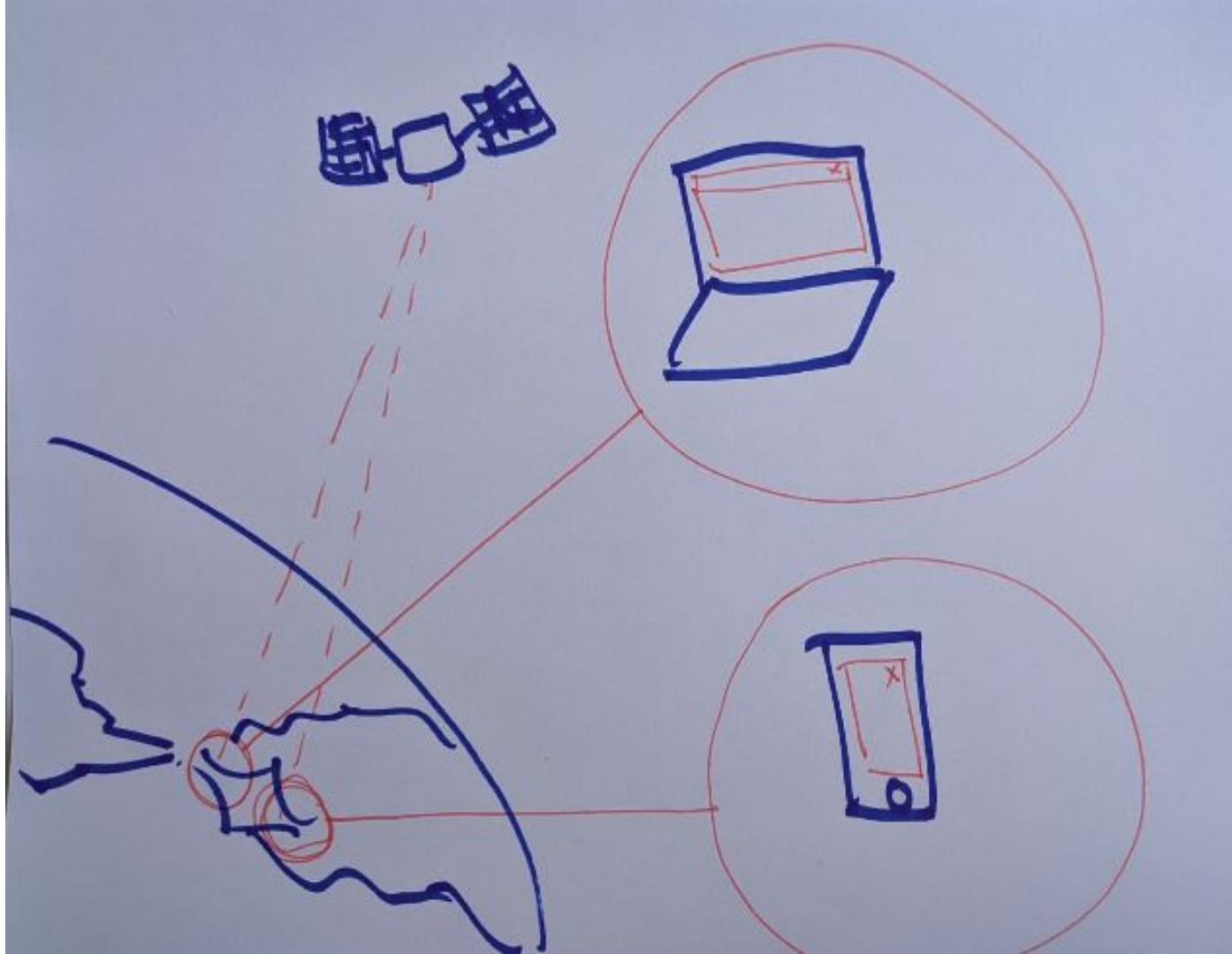
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Solution

Onboard inference,
on-ground delivery.
Small VLM on a
satellite turns flood
imagery into a
200-byte JSON
alert... no cloud, no
megabytes
downlinked.

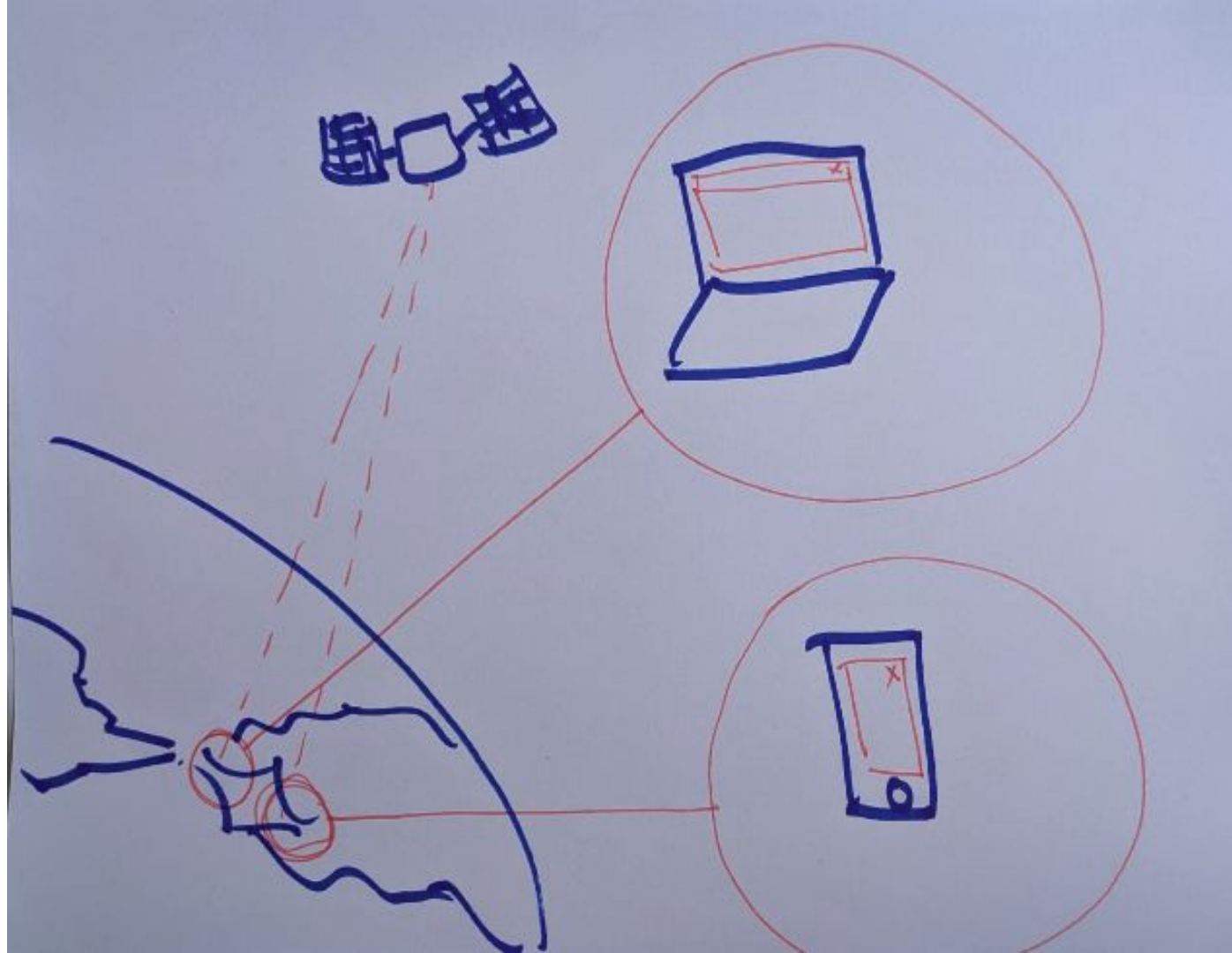


Solution

Three components,
one constraint:

Satellite VLM →
Community sync →
Local app

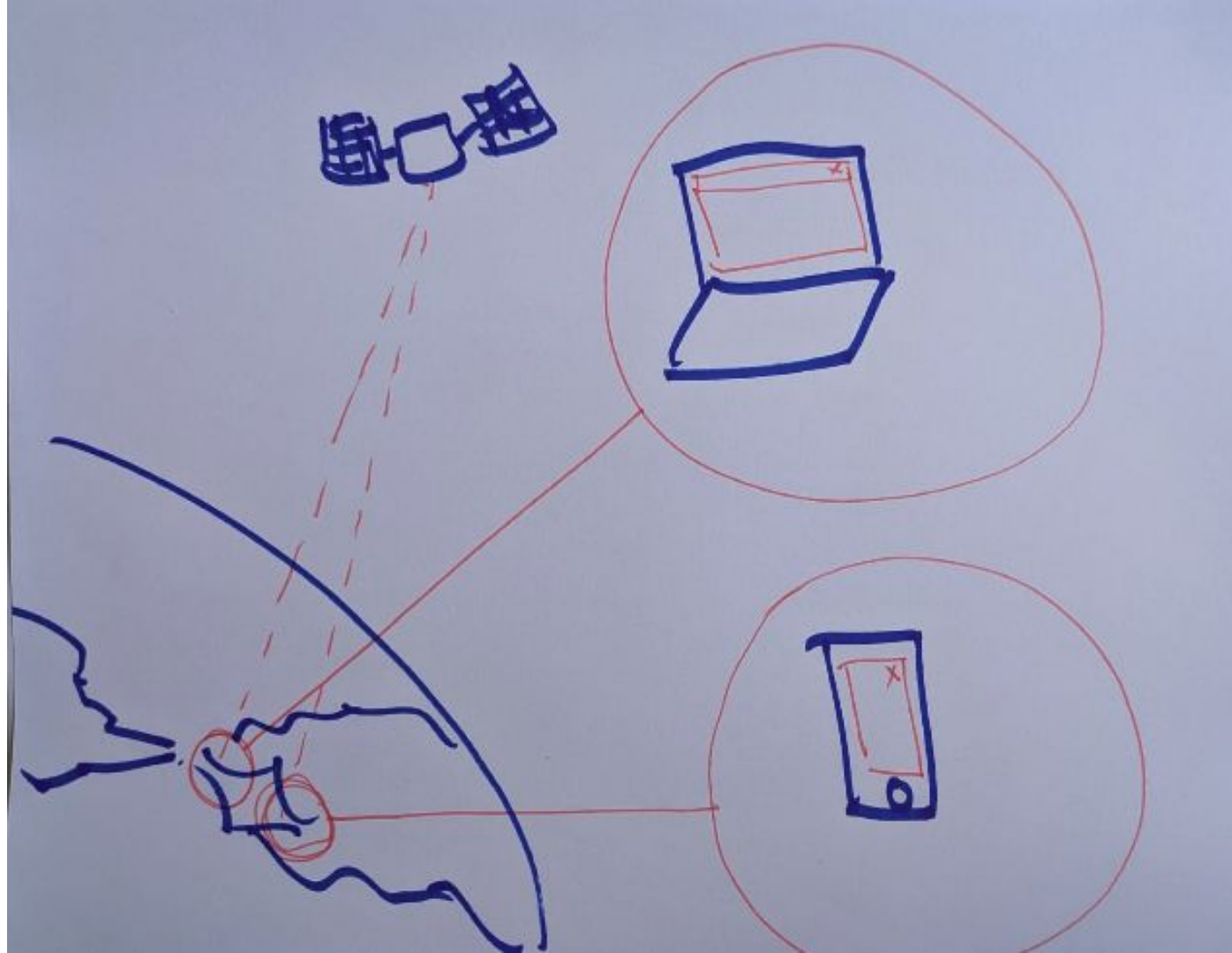
Every link can fail
without taking the next
on down.



Solution

Offline-first,
role-personalised
471 source-cited
knowledge base on
device

Retrieved locally with
Nomic + DuckDB.
Same alert, different
answers for campesino
vs alcalde vs Red
Cross respondent in
plain Spanish, with
citations, no internet
required and context



Solution



Architecture

1. SPACE (ONBOARD SATELLITE)



Flood Detection Inference



LFM2.5-VL-450M (VLM)

~245 MB Q4_0 GGUF + 50 MB mmproj

4 PNGs in (RGB + SWIR, baseline + current)



~200 bytes
7-key JSON

Runtime: llama.cpp / llama-server



Low-bandwidth
ground link

2. EARTH (COMMUNITY STATION)



- ✓ Receives JSON alerts
- ✓ Applies thresholds & dispatch rules
- ✓ Hosts kb.duckdb + Q&A content
- ✓ Syncs new KB versions (when internet available)
- ✓ Serves local network

Hardware: Raspberry-Pi class (solar-capable)

Outputs



Alerts to LAN



KB & Q&A

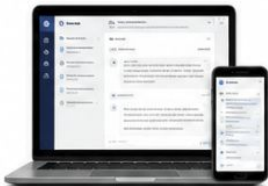


Documents



Local Wi-Fi
(No Internet)

3. GROUND (LOCAL APP)



RAG Pipeline (On-Device)

User query
(EN / ES)



nomic-embed-text
(Ollama)



DuckDB cosine search
kb.duckdb (~2.9 MB)



Top-k Q&A (cited)
(v1)

(v2)



Optional Answer Generation



LFM2 (Text)
(Ollama)



Synthesized answer
with citations

User Experience



Role × Phase × Region



Alerts feed



Q&A chat (cited)



Offline documents
(filtered)

Runtimes: Ollama (nomic-embed-text + LFM2)

Data: kb.duckdb (589 rows, 768-dim embeddings inline)

MODELS



LFM2.5-VL-450M (VLM)

~450 MB (Q4_0 245 MB + mmproj 50 MB)

Satellite-side flood detection.

4 images in → 7-key JSON out.



LFM2 (Text)

~1.2B class

Answer synthesis from top-k Q&A.

CPU-only inference.



nomic-embed-text

137M, 768-dim, multilingual

Embeds questions & queries for

cosine retrieval.

RUNTIMES (WHY TWO?)

llama.cpp / llama-server (Space)

- Only runtime that loads LFM2.5-VL mmproj
- OpenAI-compatible local API, tiny footprint

Ollama (Ground)

- One-binary install for non-technical users
- Hosts BOTH LFM2 (text) and nomic-embed-text
- Text-only path → mmproj not needed

DUCKDB INDEX (ON DEVICE)



kb.duckdb

~2.9 MB

589 rows (471 humanitarian + 118 project-meta)

Schema: role, phase, region, topic,
question_en/es, answer_en/es,
references, ref_types,
embedding FLOAT[768]

Cosine search:

array_cosine_similarity(embedding, \$query_vec)
ORDER BY 1 DESC LIMIT k



Onboard inference ships answers, not images. Local retrieval grounds those answers in real PDFs. Two runtimes — llama.cpp in orbit, Ollama on the ground — because the physics is different, but the premise is the same: small, local, grounded. **The cloud is never in the data path.**

Demo

Website

Desktop app

Android app

Inference

Knowledge
base

Question and
answer system

Alert System

